

**IMPLICATIONS OF HYBRID WORKPLACE ON EMPLOYEE
ENGAGEMENT**

PROJECT REPORT

Submitted by

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**MASTER OF ARTS IN
HUMAN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT**

Under the guidance of

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the project titled “**IMPLICATIONS OF HYBRID WORKPLACE ON EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT**” is a project work done by **Ms.Joanna Evangeline Crissy F** (2115782022012), a second year student of M.A. HRM, Madras School of Social Work (Autonomous), Egmore, Chennai in partial fulfilment of the requirement for the Award of the Degree of Master of Arts in Human Resource Management and that the project has not been used previously for the award of any Degree, Diploma, Scholarship, Fellowship or any other project title.

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DECLARATION

I, **JOANNA EVANGELINE CRISSY F** final year student of **M.A. HRM** hereby declare that the thesis entitled “**IMPLICATIONS OF HYBRID WORKPLACE ON EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT**” is the original work done by me under the guidance and supervision of **Dr. E. T. EVANGELINE**, in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the award of the degree of Master of Arts in Human Resource Management, Madras School of Social work. I further declare that the research work has not been submitted at any other University or Institution, for the award of any degree or diploma or fellowship.

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

CHAPTER NUMBER	TITLE	PAGE NO
1	Introduction	2
	1.1 The advent of Hybrid Work practices	2
	1.2 Hybrid Arrangement	3
	1.3 The Evolution of the Hybrid Workplace System	4
	1.4 The Advantages of the Hybrid Workplace System	5
	1.5 Disadvantages of a Hybrid Work Model	7
	1.6 Remote-first Model	7
	1.7 Fully Flexible Model	8
	1.8 Office-first Model	8
	1.9 Definition of employee engagement	9

	1.10 Employee Engagement in Hybrid work model	10
	1.11 Statement of the problem	12
	1.12 Scope of the study	12
	1.13 Chapterization	13
2	LITERATURE REVIEW	14
	2.1 Theoretical Review	15
	2.2 Hybrid Work Model	15
	2.3 Communication in hybrid work models	17
	2.4 Employee Engagement	18
3	Research Methodology	20
	3.1 Objectives of the study	21
	3.1.1 Primary Objective	21
	3.1.2 Secondary Objective	21
	3.2 Hypothesis of the study	22
	3.3 Research Design	23
	3.4 Sampling Method	23

	3.4.1 Study Population / Universe	23
	3.4.2 Sample Size	23
	3.5 Methods of data collection	23
	3.5.1 Primary Data	23
	3.5.2 Secondary Data	24
	3.6 Tools for Data Collection	24
	3.7 Statistical tools for data analysis	25
	3.7.1 Percentage Analysis	25
	3.7.2 Independent T Test	25
	3.8 Reliability Test	25
	3.9 Limitations of the study	26
4	DATA ANALYSIS & INTERPRETATION	27
	4.1 Percentage Analysis	28
	4.2 Statistical Analysis	58
5	CONCLUSION	62
	5.1 Summary of findings	63
	5.2 Suggestions and recommendations	66

	5.3 Conclusion	68
Appendix	Bibliography	70
	Questionnaire	73

LIST OF TABLES

TABLE E NO	TITLE	PAGE NO
4.1	Distribution of respondents based on age	28
4.2	Distribution of respondents based on gender	29
4.3	Educational Qualification classification	30
4.4	Distribution of respondents based on their designation	31
4.5	Marital Status classification	32
4.6	Distribution of respondents based on whether they have children	33
4.7	Respondents freedom to choose where they can work from by the company	34
4.8	Present work mode of the respondents	35
4.9	Work Preference of the respondents	36
4.10	Reasons for choosing 'Hybrid' as the preferred work mode.	37
4.11	Reasons for choosing 'Remote' as the preferred work mode.	38
4.12	Reasons for choosing 'In-office' as the preferred work mode.	39

4.13	Importance of working from the office	40
4.14	No of days worked in-office in a week	41
4.15	Primary mode of communication	42
4.16	Location of the team meetings	43
4.17	Feeling of individuals disconnected from the company	44
4.18	Team members working in-office on the same day	45
4.19	Hybrid work Model enhance Work-Life balance	46
4.20	A hybrid work model allows for more opportunities to instill diversity and inclusion in the business.	47
4.21	Engagement levels have fallen as a result of the hybrid work approach.	48
4.22	People in a hybrid work environment would be more engaged and driven.	49
4.23	The hybrid work approach has made it possible to communicate more easily.	50
4.24	Organization has invested in collaborative technologies.	51
4.25	Through surveys, the organization actively seeks continuous feedback from its employees.	52
4.26	Individual's feeling whether they focus hard on their work	53

4.27	Individual's feeling whether they share the same values as their colleagues	54
4.28	Individual's feeling whether they feel positive about their work	55
4.29	Individual's feeling whether they feel energetic in their work	56
4.30	Individual's engagement level in the organization	57

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Chapter – I

Introduction

The majority of businesses have adapted to fixed work hours patterns that require employees to be in the office and continue to rely on the company's physical infrastructure and equipment to complete their tasks. This scenario was completely questioned with the advent of the 2019 corona-virus pandemic. Not all traditional labor practices have held up in the face of the challenges posed by the pandemic, and some restrictions have been imposed to prevent the spread of the disease. The workplace was completely chaotic in the first few days due to the people affected by the virus and the physical and emotional turmoil caused by the rapid spread of the disease. At some point, the system had to be taken out of service because the system was not designed to withstand a disaster of this magnitude and the company did not anticipate it. The only organizations that were able to meet this challenge were those that were already working remotely to some extent. Hybrid work was a practical model already practiced by companies before the pandemic, but it was only later that the benefits of this model became apparent.

1.1 The advent of Hybrid Work practices

Chronologically, the association between workspace and living space dates back to the Stone Age. Humans originally foraged and stored in their living spaces, they cared for livestock in their spaces, and performed most of the work necessary for feeding - that was their sole purpose. - where they live. During the Middle Ages, most artisans set up a workspace in their home and had a separate space to sell them. This is a perfect example of alternating between 'at home' and 'at the office'. Professions like baking, sewing, etc. paved the way for the first exercisers in the Middle Ages. The gender gap is not a serious issue, as homeworkers can be either male or female.

1.2 Hybrid Arrangement

Hybrid systems are also called blended systems. This usually occurs in situations where two types of requirements need to be balanced in order to conflict or avoid conflict. A hybrid system is an initiative put in place to meet the specific needs of active stakeholders within a system or organization. In situations with unique requirements, a hybrid deployment should serve as a solution to the challenges of location, distance, cost, availability, and management. It is no exaggeration to say that hybrids are a derivative of technological progress.

To define what hybridity is, especially in a workspace, it combines the physical work arrangement and the remote work system (Cook et al., 2020). Basically, some work directly on the premises of a company or organization, while others work through the Internet. This arrangement could also include the same group of people who can physically show up at the company and work remotely for the rest of the week. The hybrid working system ensures the organization employing it enjoys the special advantages that come with the remote working system (Trede et al., 2019b). Key elements of the package that come with remote work are job flexibility, reduced labor costs, increased employee satisfaction, and better environmental experiences. Also added is the benefit which comes with the traditional working system. There is the assurance of hands-on interaction of the existing culture in the work organization. Likewise, there comes the advantage of informal networking, more likely in-person collaboration, and the added benefits of a structure to help foster creativity. Where both the benefits of the traditional and remote workplace system coexist is referred to as the situation of hybridity (Malhotra & Reay, 2019).

1.3 The Evolution of the Hybrid Workplace System

When talking about the evolution of the hybrid work system, it is essential to talk about why the need for a hybrid arrangement in the first place. With several businesses expanding their reach across countries with the aid of digital marketing, entrepreneurship serves as a focal point to the study of the rise of the work's hybrid system. Digitization has been a boon in the hands of many entrepreneurs, and what seemed impossible years ago is now being achieved by individual companies (La Porta, 2021).

Hybrid work systems have been around for years. Many will argue or seek to revolve around the COVID-19 pandemic and the induced lockdowns of hybridity. But it is no exaggeration to say that the world is on the verge of it, especially when it comes to work, business and education (R. Wilson, 2013). Originally, the concept of work is undergoing another industrial revolution globally. The tremendous growth of technology over the past decade has essentially made it clear that the world of work is changing. Long before the pandemic, some organizations were already impacting the structure of their hybrid work systems. As of 2015, there were predictions about what the future of work might look like. Certain job descriptions are projected to become obsolete in the coming years. Previous research on machine learning and artificial intelligence has shown that the existence of machines that perform simple tasks that humans are engaged in reduces the need for humans to occupy specific positions (Yu & Hafner, 2020).

The arrival of the COVID-19 pandemic has accelerated the rethinking of the physical workplace. The initial strike of the new virus has forced lockdowns to be implemented along with other precautions to limit the spread of the virus. It meant school replication, cancellation of conferences and other social events. Organizations have had their fair share as they have had to follow new policies of maintaining social distancing. Stakeholders had to rebuild their existing working systems. Inevitably, the idea of remote work and virtual placements was adopted (Newman & Ford, 2021). Needless to say, this was the saving grace many companies needed to stay in business. Many lost their jobs as companies prioritized and scaled back, while others cut their employees' salaries in half. Gradually, the idea of having a home office started flying around like never before. The combination of technology features already in motion

and his COVID-19 pandemic has increased the number of people working remotely (Kniffin et al., 2021). As a result, many offices are becoming more open and prepared for hybrid work design. Hybrid work environments predated his COVID-19, but it's safe to say the pandemic has had a snowball effect.

1.4 The Advantages of the Hybrid Workplace System

As the pandemic starts to subside in some parts of the world, many employees expect to see more flexible work options. However, 68 percent of organizations have no plan or detailed vision in place for **hybrid work**, according to a study by **McKinsey**.

1. Increased productivity

Hybrid models can provide flexibility and allow employees to work to their strengths, thereby increasing productivity. By fostering a culture that sees remote work as a positive alternative to intensive in-office work, teams can find a good balance between creativity and collaboration. Employees who need peace and quiet to focus or who thrive in an office environment can have the choice of where and when they are most productive.

2. Improved employee satisfaction and culture

Autonomy is the Key to Employee Satisfaction: If you provide complete autonomy and control over how, where, and when your team members work, employee satisfaction will skyrocketed.

Autonomy is also important for on-site workers. Employees returning to the office after setting their own schedule for more than a year will need to feel trusted to do the job without a manager around.

In our business, mutual appreciation and positive assumptions are guiding principles. When we don't see each other every day, it's easy to make assumptions about other employees - we always hold positive assumptions, are confident that everyone is doing their best, and make responsible decisions. If we do not understand an intention, we can ask a question such as. "Can you help me understand what you're doing and why?" Doing this takes a bit of courage sometimes, but the cultural benefits are huge.

3. More possibilities for continuous learning

Many organizations are performance oriented, but all too often the result is that people are too busy and not enough time to learn. A performance-based approach does not deliver long-term employee development. Also, high productivity can mask a tired employee.

Leaders must humbly recognize that learning does not just happen through training. Create daily opportunities for learning and reflection. It is difficult for anyone to develop sufficient mental capacity to reflect or process information when their day consists of meetings in quick succession. Encourage employees to devote time to self-development, learning and reflection. The beauty of the hybrid working model is that employees can choose when they want. This means you can schedule your work outside of normal meeting hours, so you can focus on getting to work without worrying about confusion or distractions.

4. Better collaboration and work relationships

Virtual meetings can play a big role in hybrid work. According to Microsoft, since February 2020, time spent per person in weekly Teams chats has increased by 45%, and time spent in weekly meetings in Teams has increased by more than 148%, increasing his 2 more than doubled. We need to find new ways of working that are more efficient than busy days in meetings.

1.5 Disadvantages of a Hybrid Work Model

When employees work remotely for long periods of time and focus on their own responsibilities, the bonds and camaraderie created by physical presence in the workplace can be undermined. Some employees feel demotivated and lonely when away from jokes, stories, and company activities during the day. Working and communicating in different locations increases the chances of cyber-attacks and other related issues, such as data loss. Organizations need to protect their digital footprint with continuous software upgrades, strong password management, and multi-factor authentication due to the high potential for data breaches.

Employers also have additional obligations to retrain their employees on things like secure connections, backing up data, and implementing recovery plans. This can be exacerbated when individuals go camping, as time spent at work becomes an unconscious assessment of their loyalty and commitment to the organization. Leaders face new challenges as they must understand and assess each employee's unique situation. Finding innovative solutions to legitimize co-worker communication and private life creates additional work.

1.6 Remote-first Model

Many business owners want a hybrid model for their first remote service. This includes activities that accurately reflect remote business, but with some differences. Not all workers have the same flexibility, but they still have an office as a place to work. In other words, some employees may be required to come to the office if their job requires a physical presence. While the remote-first hybrid office model may look different for each business, the rationale is that businesses should operate as fully remote businesses with staff spread across time zones and communicating primarily online. I have. This hybrid remote work approach allows employees to move and work remotely while preserving office space for location-conscious people. Still, it's important to note that remote members don't meet in person at first. Many remote companies offer employees the opportunity to retire annually while the individual continues to work for the remote company.

1.7 Fully Flexible Model

Employees may select when they want to work from an office and when they want to work from another place, in a completely flexible hybrid model. Ford has opted to provide salaried employees ultimate freedom by embracing this totally flexible approach, after experimenting with the concept of an office-centric hybrid.

Initially, it is difficult to adopt a completely flexible strategy. It can generate workers' status levels and major disparities, which benefit those who are closer to office more frequently. There are also genuine obstacles in coordination since it is hard to frequently keep track of who is in the workplace. Some organizations like HubSpot, which is moving from a remote first strategy to a completely flexible model, have opted to embrace. This approach provides employees with a range of alternatives, generally including a remote option, a flexible work option and a workstation option.

1.8 Office-first Model

Employees should mostly work from a physical office in this field. Employees are also permitted to work remotely provided they do not interfere with work tasks depending on their needs, company preferences, particular project requirements and other considerations. The next model in this hybrid work paradigm includes the office as the primary location for working. Before the worldwide pandemic, it was typical for firms to have a small fraction of their staff work remotely while the remainder worked in an office. If the whole leadership team is in the office, a remote permitted office-first approach is usual. The remainder of the firm will very certainly become office-centered as a result of this. This is due to the fact that the leadership team is more likely to become office-centric due to in-person interactions and cooperation (excluding remote workers).

1.9 Definition of employee engagement

There have been various definitions of employee engagement offered by different researchers. Employee engagement has been termed as an emotional and intellectual commitment to the organization by employees (Baumruk, 2004). If we consider the aspect of discretionary effort of employees from the point of view of OCB discussed above, then engagement is the employee's sense of purpose and focused energy that is evident to others through the display of personal initiative, adaptability, effort and persistence directed towards the organization's goals (Macey et al., 2009). Employee engagement has also been referred to as the illusive force that motivates employees to higher levels of performance (Wellins and Concelman, 2005). The definition of employee engagement for the purpose of this paper takes the view that an engaged employee would approach tasks associated with a job with a sense of self-investment, energy and passion, and these would lead to higher levels of in-role and extra-role performance (Christian et al., 2011). This paper will focus on the various stages that enable employee engagement in organizations by taking into account the relevant theories and practices in organizations

1.10 Employee Engagement in Hybrid work model

Hybrid Workforce is a promising new concept for organizations trying to fully recover. Employees in the hybrid workplace model come to work only occasionally, and most of their work is done at home. Therefore, companies must devise a strategy to keep these employees motivated. In further adjustments in the coming months, this will strengthen the image of the organization and develop a better culture. The human resources department of every company is responsible for providing the ideal employee experience. Creating such a personalized experience in itself is a huge undertaking, as each person is unique, with their own strengths and problems. The rise of hybrid and remote workforce's has further complicated matters. The challenges arise from the lack of direct involvement. Organizations should evaluate strategies for regularly interacting with different teams to encourage productivity and growth without isolating or micromanaging employees. With a hybrid workforce that includes both people who can meet and interact with each other and those who work remotely, having access to multiple communication channels can help maintain a high level of engagement. Managers are often the public face of employee engagement initiatives. develop a better culture.

Employee involvement can be hampered by being overworked, feeling separated from the rest of the team, and communication difficulties. And, in many cases, it is the managers who are the first to notice and solve these problems. Managers should be able to work successfully with both in-office and remote workers in a hybrid workforce that is heavily reliant on technology.

The right managers can help maintain a combined workforce by providing personalized opportunities, flexibility, and effective workload management. For a hybrid workforce, employee engagement will include more than just physical meetings, team collaborations, and team meetings. Companies must ensure that their workers are actively engaged and empowered to achieve company goals. This requires a culture that encourages remote work and fosters cross-functional collaboration, all of which are essential to the success of the hybrid working model. To improve the employee experience when working in the office, new techniques and technologies are also needed. Employers should highlight the benefits of direct engagement through new approaches to office architecture and interactions to

improve the office experience. Some collaborative tasks, such as brainstorming and decision-making, are best done face-to-face. When people are in close contact, spontaneous and informal cross-pollination of ideas is more likely. Therefore, companies should create office environments that encourage these characteristics of participation.

A hybrid model enables flexibility for both employers and employees, which will be essential if we're to maintain high levels of engagement in the post-pandemic world.

1.11 Statement of the problem

In the context where neither extensive remote work nor fully on-site setups are perceived as the optimal workplace solutions after the Covid- 19 pandemic, a hybrid approach may provide middle-ground, ideally combining the positive elements from both home- and corporate office workplaces, resulting in an enhanced employee engagement. The way employees engage in a mixture of hybrid (both remote and in-office) and non-hybrid (only remote or only in-office) is proven to be different in certain areas. Hence, the purpose is to understand how hybrid workplace impacts employee engagement.

1.12 Scope of the study

The outcome of this study confirms that employee engagement is affected by hybrid approach as a workplace arrangement, either positively or negatively, dependent on conditions how hybrid approach is configured and implemented. Hybrid workplace elements which impact employee engagement were identified and are presented in this paper.

1.13 Chapterization

Chapter 1: The first chapter deals with Introduction, Need and Scope of study, Profile of the Industry and also the sector/organization where the research was undertaken and finally the chapterization.

Chapter 2: The second chapter gives a theoretical and research review of the research and contains an elaborate literature survey of the subject under study.

Chapter 3: The third Chapter deals with the Research Methodology, Sampling Techniques, Sample size, Sample Elements and Limitations.

Chapter 4: The fourth chapter contains a data analysis of the research findings and their corresponding interpretation.

Chapter 5: The fifth chapter summarizes the findings, Suggestions and conclusions.

CHAPTER 2

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Chapter – 2

Review of Literature

2.1 Theoretical Review

This chapter dwells on investigating the basis for this research study. Literature review seeks to acquire relevant knowledge in terms of established facts, opinions and theories as opined by renowned and established authors through authentic and reliable means of publishing. A thorough work invested in literature review helps one understand the nature of the research, its scope, objectives and thereby tune the intention of this study as to what needs to be accomplished. This literature review seeks to examine the Hybrid Work Models and then determine its implications on employee engagement.

2.2 Hybrid Work Model

A hybrid work model involves the combination of a physical work arrangement with a remote work system (**Cook et al., 2020**). Some employees work on-site within the business or organization, while others work remotely using digital and internet collaboration tools. This approach might also involve the same group of workers physically showing up for work at the company's location on some days, and then switching to work remotely on other days.

The hybrid working system ensures the organization employing it enjoys the special advantages that come with the remote working system (**Trede et al., 2019b**). In the package that comes with remote work, essential elements are flexibility at work, reduced labor cost, more satisfaction on the part of workers, and better environmental experiences.

Office-centric hybrid companies require their employees to come into the office most of the time, but they build in one or two days each week when employees are allowed to work from another location. Companies typically select office-centric hybrid

models because they believe that when employees are co-located, they are able to more effectively develop connections and coordinate with their team members, and feel a stronger sense of belonging **(Hinds, 2021)**.

In a fully flexible Hybrid Model, employees may select when they want to work from an office and when they want to work from another place using a completely flexible hybrid model **(Kelly, 2021)**.

organizations that offer a hybrid working model have a very high score of positivity and effectiveness in providing the best place to work.**(Michal Beno,2021)**

McKinsey conducted survey **(Alexander et al., 2021)** showed that 30% of employees would likely switch jobs if their organization would consider fully on-site work after the pandemic, and over half of the informants expressed their desire for organizations to adopt more flexible hybrid virtual-working model. Those responses provide insights on how the fundamentals of the workplace, and work in general, have been impacted by the pandemic and why it is important to understand the employee engagement drivers in a less regulated workplace.

Most employees under a remote-first model work remotely by default, either from their homes or from anyplace. It's critical to understand the conceptual distinction between being remote-first and being remote-friendly as a leader. It's the difference between enabling workers to work from home and empowering them to do so. Remote-first organizations develop their processes, systems, and culture around remote employees first, which creates a significant operational difference. **(Sanders, 2020)**

2.3 Communication in hybrid work models

A hybrid model should combine both aspects of physical and virtual communication. The challenge lies in choosing when to choose either of them.

When we take a closer look at hybrid communication, we notice that it's like a coin — it has two equally important sides: the synchronous and the asynchronous side. For each team, an appropriate balance between synchronous and asynchronous communication will allow them to function properly, keep in touch during work hours, and finish projects no matter where they are. **(Anja Bojic, 2022)**

Although additional study is needed to fully comprehend the long-term implications of implementing a synergistic cooperation model, it is apparent that such a hybrid approach effectively blends rich face-to-face and efficient virtual communication to optimize synergy **(Williams et al., 2015)**

Face-to-face interactions don't have to take place in the same physical location. Output can be achieved through video conferencing or a more casual video chat. This type of interaction helps in the transfer of culture, boosts collaboration and productivity and ensures equity and equality at work **(Kalwani, 2021)**.

synchronous communication simply means that the person you are "talking" to is not absorbing the information as you provide it. Email is a good example of asynchronous communication because both parties do not need to access it at the same time. to help analyze how people interact. People may improve their communication by being more precise about which style of communication is appropriate for whatever scenario **(Chad, 2021)**

2.4 Employee Engagement

The term employee engagement was initially coined by **Kahn (1990)** to describe the extent of the physical, cognitive, and emotional presence exhibited by people at work.

For a mixed workforce, employee engagement will include more than just physical meetings, team collaborations, and team meetings. Companies must ensure that their workers are actively engaged and empowered to achieve company goals. This requires a culture that encourages remote work and fosters cross-functional collaboration, all of which are essential to the success of the hybrid working model. Managers are often the public face of employee engagement initiatives. Employee engagement can be hampered by overwork, feeling isolated from the rest of the team, and communication difficulties. Managers should be able to work successfully with both in-office and remote workers in a hybrid workforce that is heavily reliant on technology. The proper managers can help sustain a hybrid workforce by providing individualized opportunities, flexibility, and effective workload management. **(Mukerjee, 2020)**

Having well-defined meeting agendas also aids in the prevention of burnout, which is one of the most common complaints among employees. Setting a precise agenda with defined objectives aids in identifying the individuals who actually need to attend a meeting, maximizes everyone's time, and makes each participant feel important and productive. Employees may feel as though their efforts go unappreciated in a mixed workplace when face time is limited. Celebrating and praising people's accomplishments, no matter how minor, goes a long way toward keeping a team engaged. **(Dismore, 2021)**

It's important for leaders to maintain a team culture and help employees build resilience in flexible or mixed work situations. These employees have never had the opportunity to collaborate with their colleagues due to the strict rules of the pandemic. Workers will see their productivity increase as business returns to the workplace. It's

important for distant workers to be able to interact electronically with one another. Regular check-ins and team events may assist boost employee confidence and help them thrive in a post-pandemic hybrid workplace. **(Sinead, 2021)**

Engaged employees have a desire to make a difference as well as a strong concern to perform and work well inside the company **(Chanana, 2020)**.

COVID-19 has drastically changed the ways of working by forcing RW as a long-term and extensive solution, consequently impacting employee engagement in several ways. **Slavkovic (2022)** highlights the correlation between loneliness, due to working from home, and a lower work engagement.

Increased stress related to remote working impacts negatively employee engagement **(Adisa, 2021)**.

An extensive body of literature has found that work-life balance has an impact on employee engagement **(Halbesleben, 2010, Timms et al., 2015)**. In case of a lack of resources, this could engender work-life conflict, harming engagement **(Mache et al., 2016)**.

CHAPTER-3

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

3.1 Objectives of the study:

3.1.1 Primary Objective:

- To study the implications of Hybrid work model on Employee Engagement.

3.1.2 Secondary Objective:

- To study the difference in Engagement levels between Hybrid and Non-hybrid work models.
- To study the difference in Employee Engagement among male and female gender.
- To determine the difference in Employee Engagement levels among the primary modes of communication.

3.2 Hypothesis of the study:

Hypothesis - 1

H₀: There exists no significant difference in Employee engagement levels between hybrid and Non-hybrid work models.

H₁: There exists a significant difference in Employee engagement levels between hybrid and Non-hybrid work models.

Hypothesis - 2

H₀: There exists no significant difference in engagement levels among Male and Female.

H₁: There exists a significant difference in engagement levels among Male and Female.

Hypothesis - 3

H₀: There exists no significant relationship between hybrid work model and work life balance.

H₁: There exists a significant relationship between hybrid work model and work life balance.

3.3 Research Design:

The study is based on Non – Probability Convenience Sampling. The researcher selected the accessible target group by selecting the companies in IT and adopted convenience sampling method to achieve the sample size.

3.4 Sampling Method :

The study is based on Non – Probability Convenience Sampling. The researcher selected the accessible target group by selecting the companies in IT, Manufacturing and Service Sector Chennai and adopted convenience sampling method to achieve the sample size.

3.4.1 Study Population / Universe:

All items in any field of inquiry constitute a Universe or Population. The population of the research is the employees of different age groups, genders and years of experience working in the IT sector organizations in Chennai.

3.4.2 Sample Size:

Sample size acts as the representative population of the whole universe hence the size of the sample is an important factor in determining the validity of the study. The sample size of the study is 80 respondents.

3.5 Methods of data collection:

Data is a set of information which enables the researcher to find solution to a problem in hand. Data also includes descriptive facts, non-numerical information, quantitative and qualitative information. The researcher had collected data from both primary and secondary data.

3.5.1 Primary Data:

Primary data is a type of information that is obtained directly from first-hand sources by means of surveys, observation or experimentation. It is data that has not been previously published and is derived from a new or original research study and collected at the source.

3.5.2 Secondary Data:

Secondary data is research data that has previously been gathered and can be accessed by researchers. Secondary data is readily available from the other sources and as such, there are no specific collection methods. This includes data from journals, magazines, newspapers and internet.

3.6 Tools for Data Collection:

The researcher used 'Questionnaire' through Google forms as an instrument for collecting primary data, which proves to be less expensive and yet elaborative, when compared to other methods. The questionnaire consists of a set of well- formulated questions to probe and obtain responses from the respondents.

For the first part of the questionnaire, the researcher collected the demographic details like , Age, Gender, Preference of work mode etc

For the Second part of the questionnaire, the researcher used is used the 24-item organizational commitment instrument created by Meyer and Allen in 1997 to collect data on the Likert-5 point scale by using “Strongly Agree” =5, “Agree” =4, “Neutral”=3, “Disagree” =2 and “Strongly Disagree” =1.

3.7 Statistical tools for data analysis:

3.7.1 Percentage Analysis:

Percentage Analysis One of the simplest methods to analyse data is the percentage method. With the help of percentage analysis, the data gets reduced in the standard form with the base equal to 100 which facilitates relative comparison. In this research study, the percentage analysis is been used for the data interpretation. The formula used:

Percentage of the respondents = Number of respondents x 100 /Total number of respondents

3.7.2 Independent T Test: Independent (or unpaired two sample) t-test is used to compare the means of two unrelated groups of samples.

Independent t-test formula

$$t = \frac{\bar{X}_1 - \bar{X}_2}{\sqrt{\frac{s_1^2}{N_1} + \frac{s_2^2}{N_2}}}$$

3.8 Reliability Test:

Cronbach's alpha is commonly used measure of reliability for a set of two or more construct indicators. With values ranging from 0 to 1.0, the higher value indicates a higher reliability among the items. Cronbach's alpha is used in this research to access the scale's internal consistency in terms of how well the items measured the same construct or dimension of perceived training quality. Although a commonly used benchmark for acceptable reliability is 0.60, lower values have been deemed acceptable when the research is descriptive in nature. The overall reliability value for this research is 0.569.

3.9 Limitations of the study:

- The research takes into account a sample size that may not be entirely reflective of the entire population.
- Distinctions haven't been made with regard to the industry the respondents are a part of there may be further scope for research.
- Distinction is made in terms of respondents who are in a hybrid work model and a non-hybrid work model – either fully remote or fully in-office. The Engagement levels within the non-hybrid work models can be studied further though this research has not attempted on it.

CHAPTER – 4

DATA ANALYSIS

AND INTERPRETATION

4.1 PERCENTAGE ANALYSIS

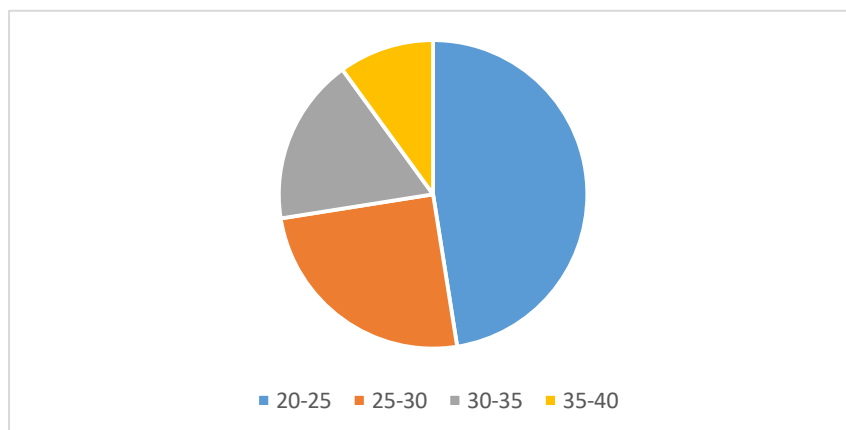
Each question from the questionnaire which is the source of primary data collected is converted in the form of tables. The table illustrates the classification of the data collected and the percentages of data and other relevant statistical information.

DEMOGRAPHIC DETAILS

Table 4.1: Distribution of respondents based on age

Age	No of respondents	Percentage
20-25	38	47
25-30	20	25
30-35	14	18
35-40	8	10
Total	80	100

Figure 4.1: Distribution of respondents based on age



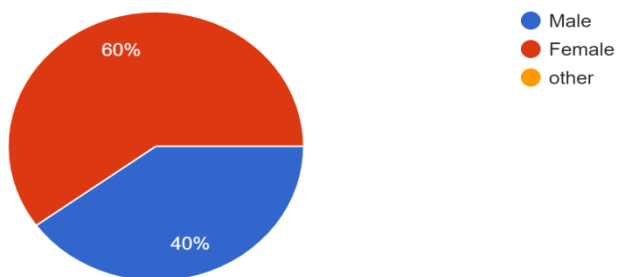
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.1 that 47% of the respondents are aged between 20 and 25 and 25% are aged between 25 and 30; 18% of the respondents are aged between 30 and 35 whereas 10% of the respondents are between 35-40.

Table 4.2: Distribution of respondents based on gender

Gender	No of Respondents	Percentage
Male	32	40
Female	48	60
Total	80	100

Figure 4.2: Gender-wise classifications

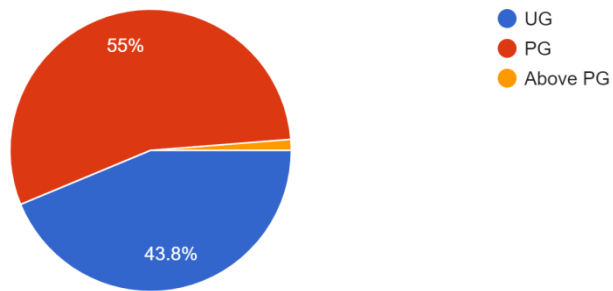


Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.2 that 40% of the respondents are male and 60% of the respondents are female. Thus, the majority of the respondents are Female.

Figure 4.3: Educational Qualification of the respondents

Educational Qualification	No of respondents	Percentage
UG	44	55
PG	34	43
Above PG	2	2
Total	80	100



Inference:

It is inferred from the table 4.3 that the respondents have completed minimum educational qualification of under graduation. 43% of the respondents have completed their under graduation and 55% of the respondents have completed their post-graduation and 2% of the respondents have completed their graduation in qualifications higher than post-graduation.

Table 4.4: Distribution of respondents based on their designation

Designation	No of Respondents	Percentage
Senior SE	20	25
Quality Analyst	14	17
Full Stack Developer	10	12
Senior Manager	7	9
Engineer	9	11
Analyst	2	3
Tester	3	4
HR	4	5
Assistant Manager	5	6
Assistant Executive	6	8
Total	80	100

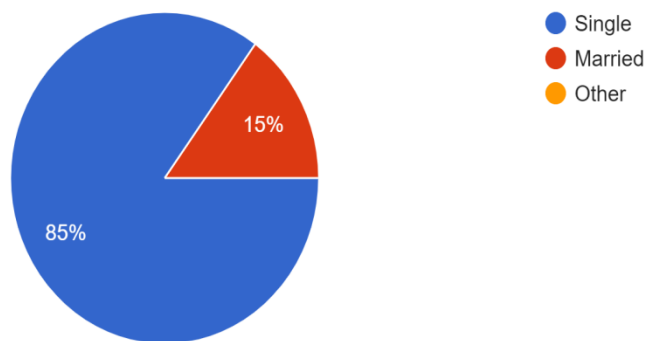
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.4 that 25% (majority) of the respondents are Senior Software Engineers and 17% are Quality Analysts; 12% of the respondents are Full Stack Developer while 9% are Senior Managers; 11% of the respondents are engineers as 3% are Analysts; 4% of the respondents are Testers and 5% are Hr; 6% of the respondents are Assistant Managers and 8% of the respondents are ASsistant Executives.

Table 4.5 Marital Status classification

Marital Status	No of Respondents	Percentage
Single	68	85
Married	12	15
Other	0	0
Total	80	100

Figure 4.4: Marital Status of the respondents



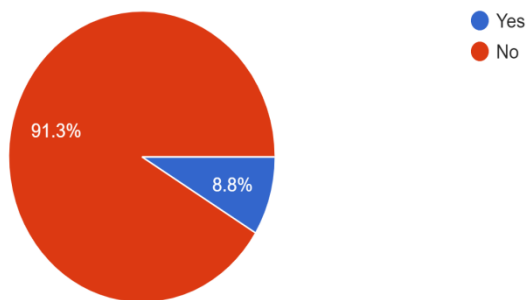
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.5 that 15% of the respondents are married and 85% of the respondents are Single .

Table 4.6: Distribution of respondents based on whether they have children

Children	No of Respondents	Percentage
yes	7	8.8
No	73	91.3
Total	80	100

Figure 4.5: Children



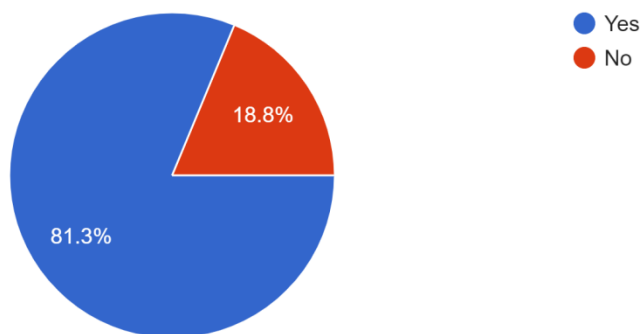
Inference:

From the table 4.7 it can be inferred that 8.8% of the respondents have children and 91.3% of the respondents do not have children.

Table 4.7: Respondents freedom to choose where they can work from by the company

Freedom To Choose	No of Respondents	Percentage
yes	65	81.3
No	15	18.8
Total	80	100

Figure 4.6: Respondents freedom to choose where they can work from by the company



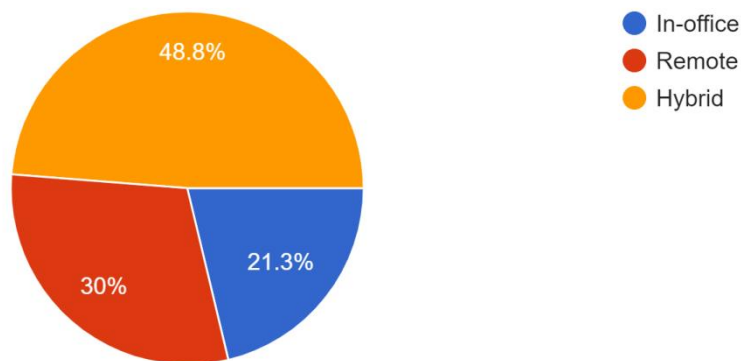
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.8 that 81.3% of the respondents have freedom of choice given by their company to choose where they can work from and 18.8% of the respondents are not given the freedom to choose where they can work from by the company

Table 4.8: Present work mode of the respondents

Current Work Mode	No of Respondents	Percentage
In Office	17	21.3
Remote	24	30
Hybrid	39	48.8
Total	80	100

Figure 4.7: Current work mode of the respondents



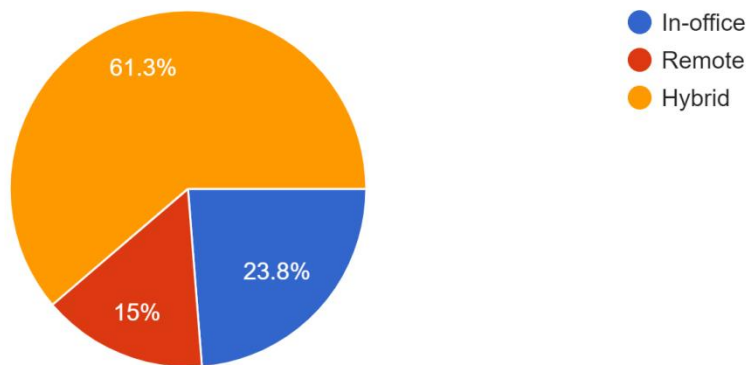
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.9 that 21.3% of the respondents are in-office workers ,30% of the respondents are Remote workers and 48.8% of respondents are hybrid workers.

Table 4.9: Work Preference of the respondents

Work Preference	No of Respondents	Percentage
In Office	19	23.8
Remote	12	15
Hybrid	49	61.3
Total	80	100

Figure 4.8: Work mode preferences of the respondents

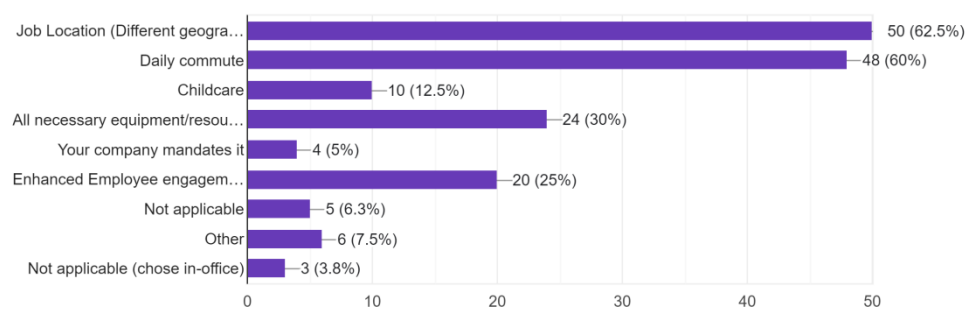


Inference:

It is inferred from the table 4.10 that 23.8% of the respondents prefer to do in-office work , 15% of the respondents prefer to do remote work and 61.3 of the respondents prefer Hybrid working model.

Table 4.10: Reasons for choosing ‘Hybrid’ as the preferred work mode.

Reasons	No of Respondents	Percentage
Job Location (Different Geographic Locations)	50	62
Daily Commute	48	60
Childcare	10	12
All necessary equipment/resources already available for remote work	24	30
Enhanced Employee Engagement	20	25
Company mandates it	4	5
Not applicable	5	6
Other	6	7.5

Figure 4.9: Reasons for choosing ‘Hybrid’ as the preferred work mode.**Inference:**

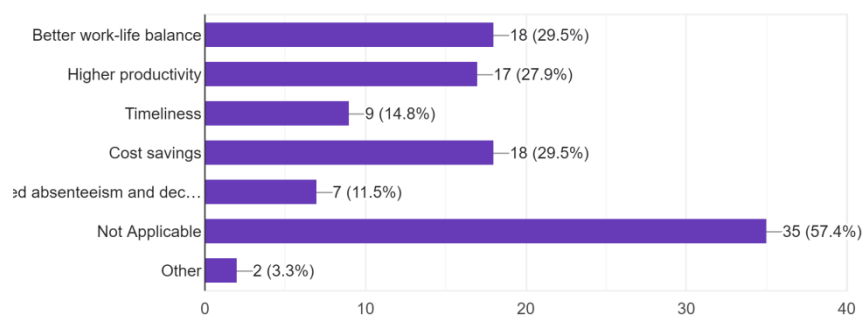
It is inferred from table 4.11 that respondents choose several reasons as to why they chose ‘Hybrid’ as their work mode preference. 6% of the respondents chose different geographic location of the job as the reason and 60% chose daily commute; 12% chose remote work due to child care; 30% already have all the necessary resources for remote work; 4% of the respondents have chosen this mode as their company

mandates it; ,25% of the respondents have chosen Enhanced employee engagement; 80% chose Hybrid work to Balance work and life.

Table 4.11: Reasons for choosing ‘Remote’ as the preferred work mode.

Reasons	No of Respondents	Percentage
Better Work-life Balance	18	29.5
Higher Productivity	17	27
Timeliness	9	14
Cost Saving	18	29
Reduced Absenteeism	7	11.5
Not Applicable	35	57.4
Other	2	3.3

Figure 4.10: Reasons for choosing ‘Remote’ as the preferred work mode.



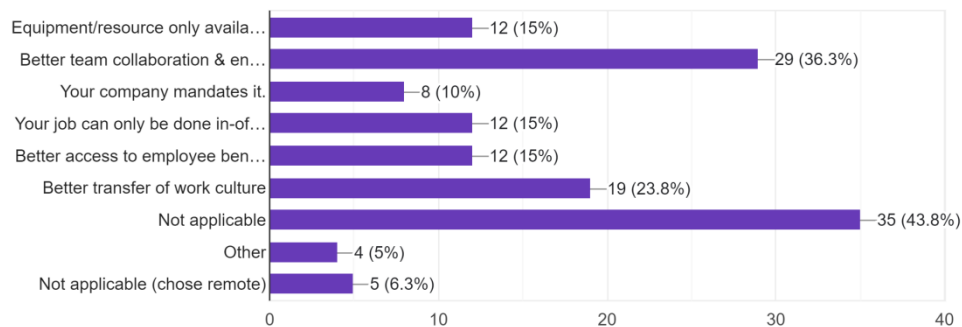
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.12 that respondents choose several reasons as to why they chose ‘Remote’ as their work mode preference. 29.5% of the respondents chose better work-life balance as the reason and 27.9% chose Higher Productivity; 14.8% chose remote work due to Timeliness; 29.5% chose cost saving; 11.5% of the respondents have chosen this mode as it reduces absenteeism;

Table 4.12: Reasons for choosing ‘In-office’ as the preferred work mode.

Reasons	No of Respondents	Percentage
Equipment/Resources only available in office	12	15
Better Team engagement	29	36
Your company mandates it	8	12
Your job can be only done in office	12	15
Better access to employee benefits	12	15
Better transfer of work culture	19	23
Not applicable	35	43
Other	4	5

Figure 4.11: Reasons for choosing ‘In-Office’ as the preferred work mode.



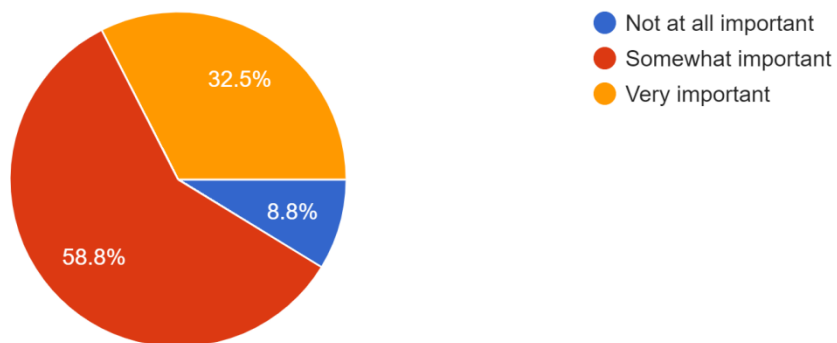
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.13 that respondents choose several reasons as to why they chose ‘In-Office’ as their work mode preference. 15% of the respondents chose Equipment/Resource only available in office as the reason and 36% chose Better team engagement; 10% chose In-office work Because company mandates it; 15% chose job can be done only in office; 23.8% of the respondents have chosen this mode as it helps in better transfer of work culture;

Table 4.13: Importance of working from the office

Level of importance	No of Respondents	Percentage
Very Important	26	32
Somewhat Important	47	58.8
Not at all Important	7	8.8

Figure 4.12: Importance of working from the office



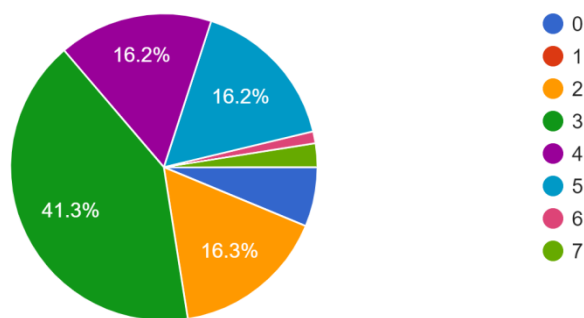
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.14 that 32% of the respondents feel that working from office is very important and 58% of the respondents feel that working from the office is somewhat important whereas 32% of the respondents feel that working from the office is not at all important.

Table 4.14: No of days worked in-office in a week

No.of days	No of Respondents	Percentage
0	5	6.3
1	1	1.2
2	13	16.3
3	33	41.3
4	13	16.2
5	13	16.2
6	1	1.2
Total	80	100

Figure 4.13:No.of days worked in office a week



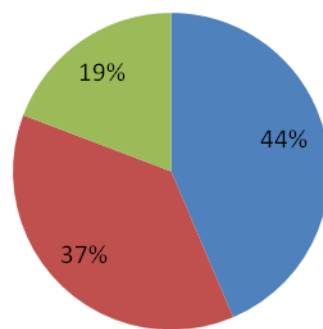
Inferences: It is inferred from the Table 4.16 that 6.3% of the respondents do not work in-office, 1.2% of respondents work in-office once a week, 16.3% of the respondents work in-office twice a week, 41.3%(Majority) of the respondents work in-office three times a week, 16.2% of the respondents work in-office four days a week, 16.2% of the respondents work in-office five days a week, 1.2% of the respondents work in-office six days a week.

Table 4.15 Primary mode of communication

No.of days	No of Respondents	Percentage
Emails	34	42
Phone calls	29	36
In-Person	15	18

Figure 4.14: Primary mode of communication

■ Emails ■ Phone calls ■ In-Person

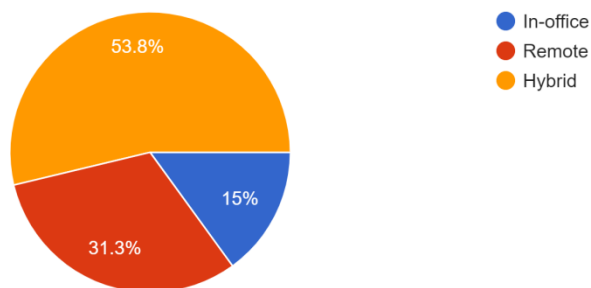


Inferences: It is inferred from Table 4.16 that 34% (majority) of the respondents' primary mode of communication is Email, 29% of the respondents' primary mode of communication in Phone Calls, 15% of respondents' primary mode of communication is in-person communication

Table 4.16: Location of the team meetings

Location	No of Respondents	Percentage
In-Office	12	15
Remote	25	31
Hybrid	43	53
Total	80	100

Figure 4.15: Location of the team meetings.



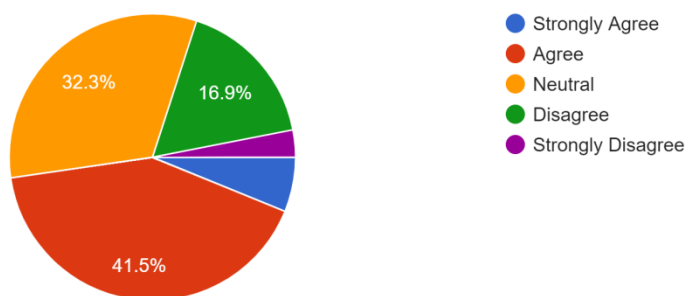
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.17 that 15% of respondents' team meetings occur in-office whereas 31.3% of the respondents' meetings are remote meetings while 53.8% of the respondents have hybrid meetings.

Table 4.17: Feeling of individuals disconnected from the company

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Agree	4	6.2
Agree	30	41.5
Neutral	28	32.3
Disagree	16	16.9
Strongly Disagree	2	3.1
Total	80	100

Figure 4.16: Feeling of individuals disconnected from the company



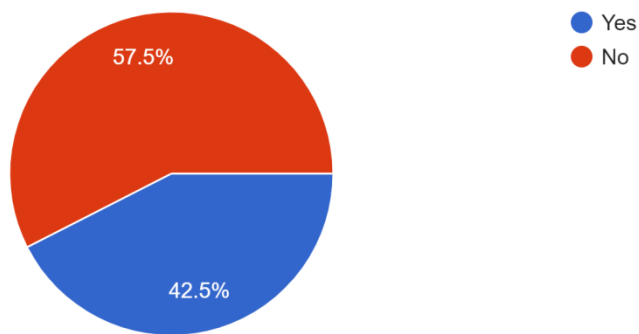
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.18 that 6.2% of respondents strongly agree that they feel disconnected from the rest of the company while 41% also agree to that statement; 32.3% of the respondents have a neutral opinion to that statement while 16.9% of the respondents disagree that their team members have a trusting and respectful relationship with each other.

Table 4.18 Team members working in-office on the same day

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Yes	33	42
No	45	57
Total	80	100

Figure 4.17: Team members working in-office on the same day



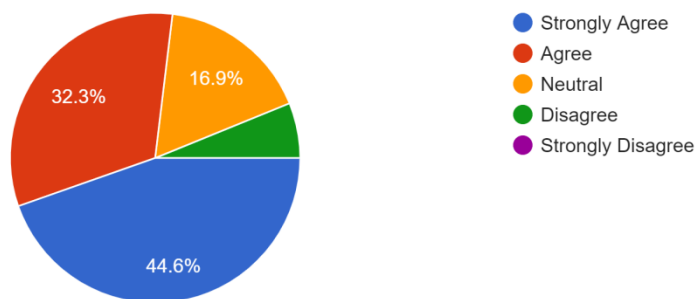
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.19 that 42.5% of the respondents' team members work in the office on the same days whereas 57.5(Majority)% of the respondents' team members do not work in the office on the same day

Table 4.19 Hybrid work Model enhance Work-Life balance

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Agree	29	44.6
Agree	21	32.3
Neutral	11	16.9
Disagree	4	6.2
Strongly Disagree	15	2
Total	80	100

Figure 4.17: Hybrid work Model enhance Work-Life balance



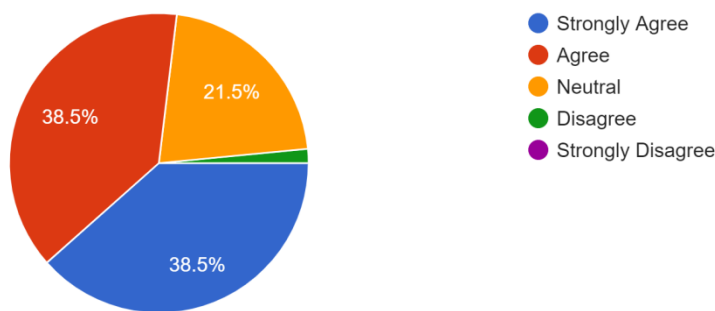
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.20 that 44.6% of respondents strongly agree that Hybrid work model enhance work -life balance while 32.3% also agree to that statement; 16.9% of the respondents have a neutral opinion to that statement while 6.2% of the respondents disagree to the statement.

Table 4.20 A hybrid work model allows for more opportunities to instill diversity and inclusion in the business.

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Agree	30	38
Agree	32	38
Neutral	17	21
Disagree	1	1.5
Strongly Disagree	0	0
Total	80	100

Figure 4.18: A hybrid work model allows for more opportunities to instill diversity and inclusion in the business.



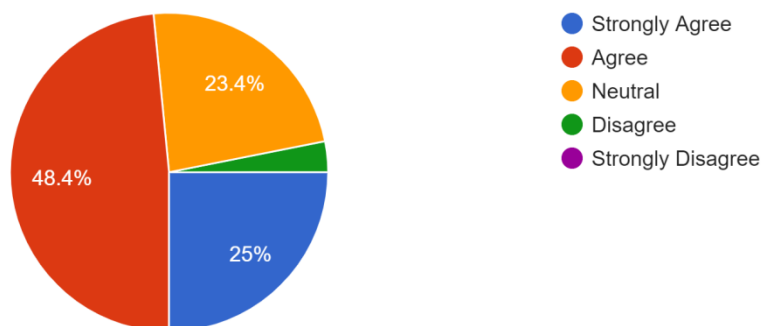
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.21 that 38.5% of respondents strongly agree that Hybrid work model improves diversity & Inclusion in Business while 38.5% also agree to that statement; 21.5% of the respondents have a neutral opinion to that statement while 1.5% of the respondents disagree to the statement.

Table 4.21 Engagement levels have fallen as a result of the hybrid work approach.

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Agree	21	25
Agree	35	48
Neutral	21	23
Disagree	3	3.1
Strongly Disagree	0	0
Total	80	100

Figure 4.18: Engagement levels have fallen as a result of the hybrid work approach.



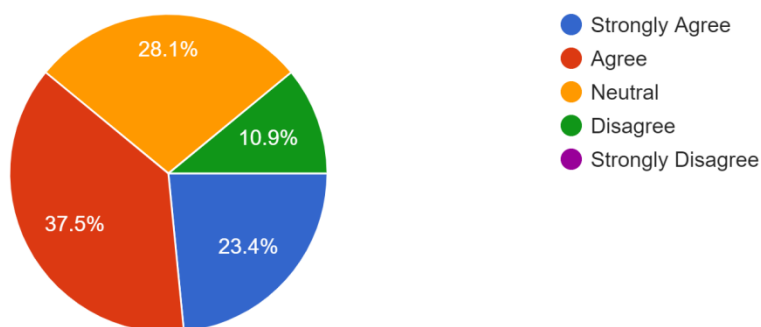
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.22 that 25% of respondents strongly agree that engagement levels have fallen while 48.4% also agree to that statement; 23.4% of the respondents have a neutral opinion to that statement while 3.1% of the respondents disagree to the statement.

Table 4.22 People in a hybrid work environment would be more engaged and driven.

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Agree	17	23
Agree	33	37
Neutral	20	28
Disagree	9	10.9
Strongly Disagree	1	2
Total	80	100

Figure 4.19: People in a hybrid work environment would be more engaged and driven.



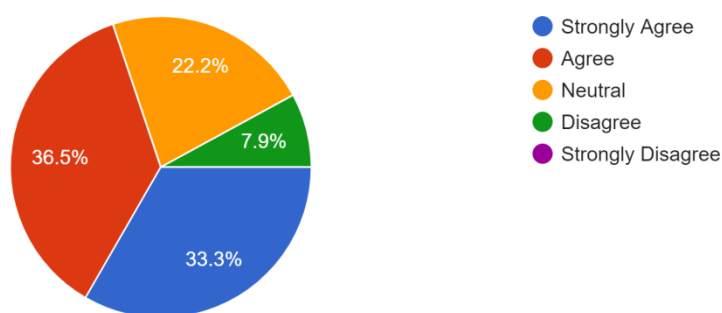
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.23 that 23.4% of respondents strongly agree that people in hybrid work model are more engaged and driven while 37.5% also agree to that statement; 28.1% of the respondents have a neutral opinion to that statement while 10.9% of the respondents disagree to the statement.

Table 4.23 The hybrid work approach has made it possible to communicate more easily.

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Agree	28	33.3
Agree	27	36.5
Neutral	15	22.2
Disagree	7	7.9
Strongly Disagree	0	0
Total	80	100

Figure 4.20: The hybrid work approach has made it possible to communicate more easily.



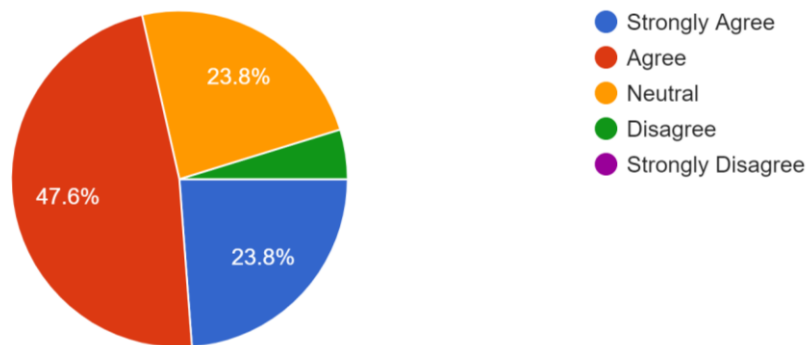
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.24 that 33.3% of respondents strongly agree that Hybrid work model has made communication easy while 36.5% also agree to that statement; 22.2% of the respondents have a neutral opinion to that statement while 7.9% of the respondents disagree to the statement.

Table 4.24 Organization has invested in collaborative technologies.

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Agree	24	23.8
Agree	33	47.6
Neutral	19	23.8
Disagree	4	4.8
Strongly Disagree	0	0
Total	80	100

Figure 4.21: Organization has invested in collaborative technologies.



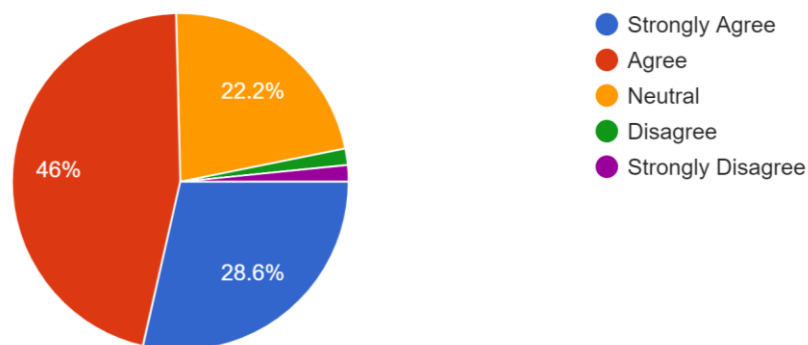
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.25 that 23.8% of respondents strongly agree that to assist Hybrid work model Organizations has invested in collaborative technologies while 47.6% also agree to that statement; 23.8% of the respondents have a neutral opinion to that statement while 4.8% of the respondents disagree to the statement.

Table 4.25 Through surveys, the organization actively seeks continuous feedback from its employees.

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Agree	25	28.6
Agree	32	46
Neutral	17	20.2
Disagree	3	2.2
Strongly Disagree	1	1.6
Total	80	100

Figure 4.22: Through surveys, the organization actively seeks continuous feedback from its employees



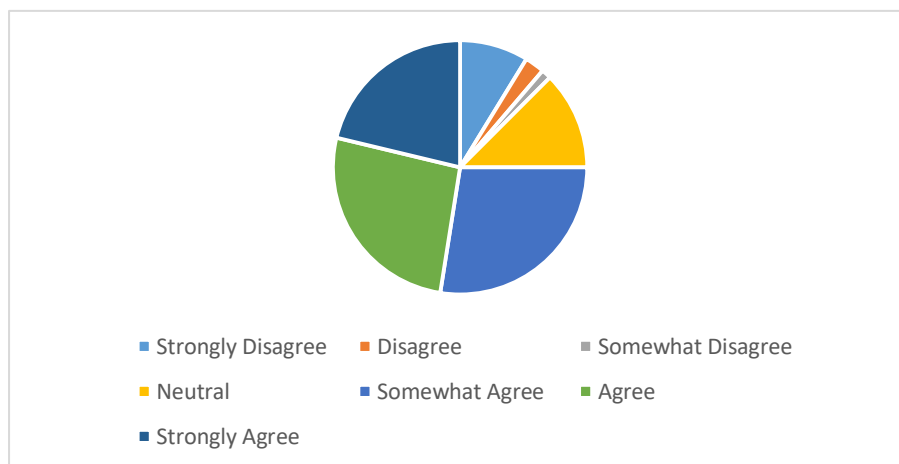
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.26 that 28.6% of respondents strongly agree that Organizations continuously seeks feedback from its employees while 46% also agree to that statement; 22.2% of the respondents have a neutral opinion to that statement while 2.2% of the respondents disagree to the statement.

Table 4.26 Individual's feeling whether they focus hard on their work

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Disagree	7	8.7
Disagree	2	2.5
Somewhat Disagree	1	1.2
Neutral	10	12.5
Somewhat Agree	22	27.5
Agree	21	26.2
Strongly Agree	17	21.2
Total	80	100

Figure 4.23: Individual's feeling whether they focus hard on their work



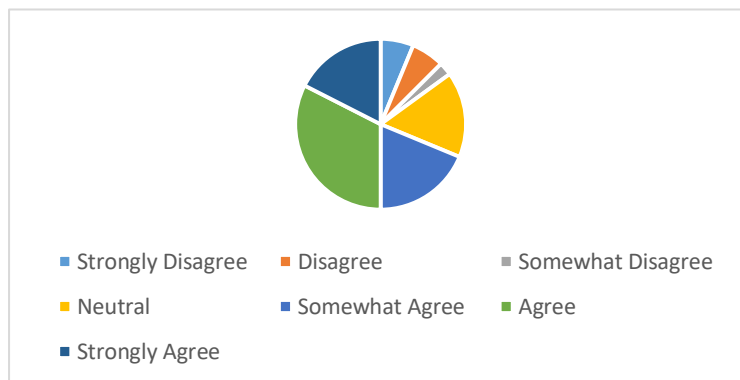
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.27 that 21.2% of the respondents strongly agree that they focus hard on their work and 26.2% agree to that statement while 27.5% of the respondents somewhat agree; 12.5% of the respondents have a neutral opinion on the statement while 2.5% of the respondents disagree that they focus hard on their work.

Table 4.27 : Individual's feeling whether they share the same values as their colleagues

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Disagree	5	6.2
Disagree	5	6.2
Somewhat Disagree	2	2.5
Neutral	13	16.2
Somewhat Agree	15	18.7
Agree	26	32.5
Strongly Agree	14	17.5
Total	80	100

Figure 4.24: Individual's feeling whether they share the same values as their colleagues



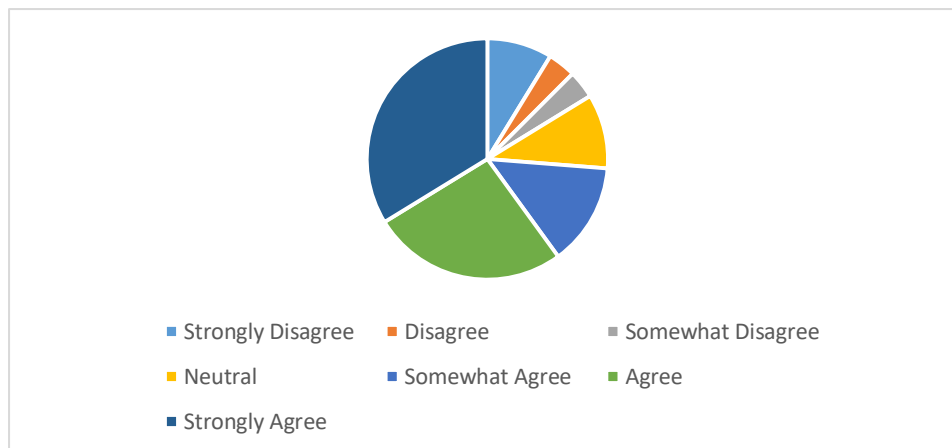
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.28 that 32.5% of the respondents agree that they share the same work values as their colleagues and 17.5% strongly agree to that statement while 18.7% somewhat agree; 16.2% of the respondents have a neutral opinion on that statement whereas 6.2% of the respondents have disagreed that they share the same work values as their colleagues.

Table 4.28: Individual's feeling whether they feel positive about their work

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Disagree	7	8.7
Disagree	3	3.7
Somewhat Disagree	3	3.7
Neutral	8	10
Somewhat Agree	11	13.7
Agree	21	26.2
Strongly Agree	27	33.3
Total	80	100

Figure 4.25: Individual's feeling whether they feel positive about their work



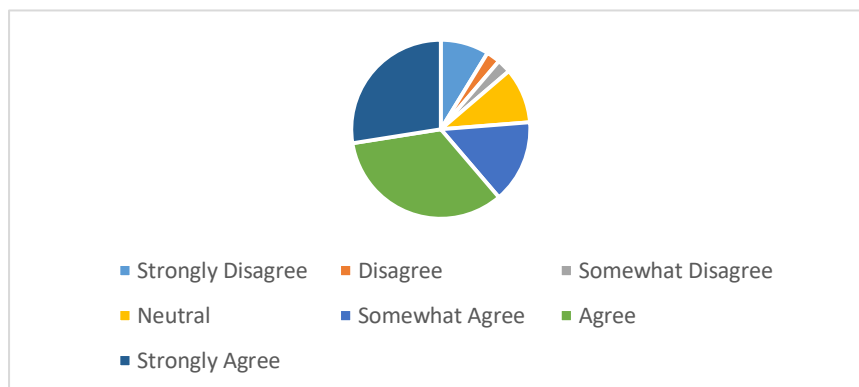
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.29 that 26.2% of the respondents agree that they feel positive about their work and 33.3% strongly agree to that statement while 13.7% somewhat agree; 10% of the respondents have a neutral opinion on that statement whereas 3.7% of the respondents disagree as they do not feel positive about their work.

Table 4.29: Individual's feeling whether they feel energetic in their work

Particulars	No of Respondents	Percentage
Strongly Disagree	7	8.7
Disagree	2	2.5
Somewhat Disagree	2	2.5
Neutral	8	10
Somewhat Agree	12	15
Agree	27	33.7
Strongly Agree	22	27
Total	80	100

Figure 4.26: Individual's feeling whether they feel energetic in their work



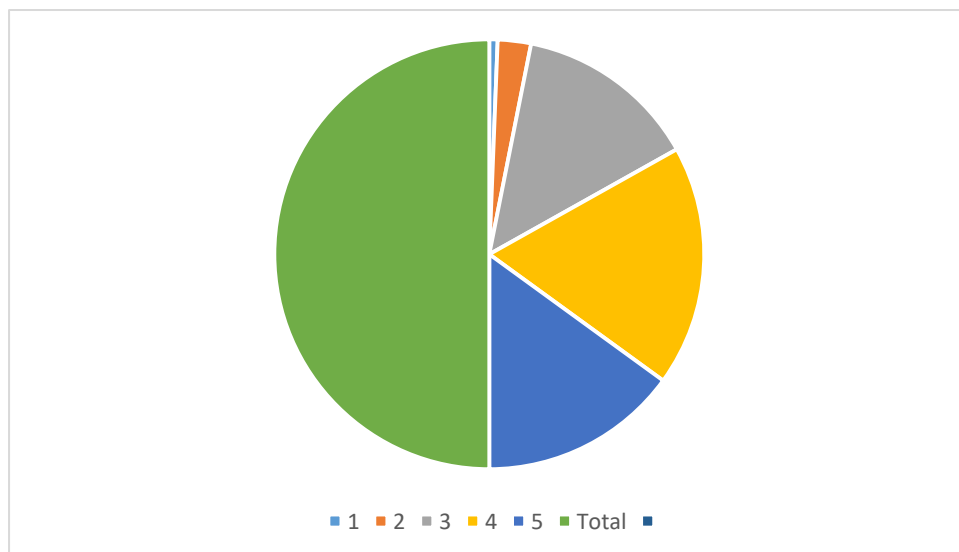
Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.30 that 27% of the respondents strongly agree that they feel energetic in their work and 33.7% agree to that statement while 15% somewhat agree; 10% of the respondents have a neutral opinion whereas 2.5% of the respondents disagree as they do not feel energetic in their work.

Table 4.30: Individual's engagement level in the organization

Scale	No of Respondents	Percentage
1	1	1.2
2	4	5
3	22	27.5
4	29	36.2
5	24	30
Total	80	100

Figure 4.27: Individual's engagement level in the organisation



Inference:

It is inferred from table 4.31 that 36.2%(Majority)has rated 4 for their engagement levels in the organization while 30% of the respondents have rated 5 and 27.5% Has rated 3 to that statement while 5%has rated 2; and 1.2% of the respondents have rated 1.

4.2 Statistical Analysis

Independent sample T-test

Hypothesis - 1

H₀: There exists no significant difference in Employee engagement levels between hybrid and Non-hybrid work models.

H₁: There exists a significant difference in Employee engagement levels between hybrid and Non-hybrid work models.

Table 4.2.1: Difference in Employee Engagement levels in work models

Work Models	Mean	T	DF	Sig.(2-Tailed)
Non-Hybrid	2.8065	-7.046	78	.000
Hybrid	4.0816			

Inference:

From the above table it can be inferred that the probability value 0.00 is less than 0.05 alpha value ,therefore we reject H₀ and accept H₁. Hence there exists a statistically proven difference in Employee Engagement levels in Hybrid and Non-hybrid Work Models. This may be due to reasons such as increased flexibility provided by the Hybrid Work Models, consistent team meetings irrespective of whether work modes are remote or on-site in the hybrid model, and the relative stability of Work-life balance that is provide by the Hybrid Work Models.

Hypothesis - 2

H₀: There exists no significant difference in engagement levels among Male and Female.

H₁: There exists significant difference in engagement levels among Male and Female.

Table 4.2.2: Difference in Employee Engagement Levels among male and female gender

Gender	Mean	T	DF	Sig.(2-Tailed)
Male	3.9688	0.628	78	0.532
Female	3.8333			

Inference: P value is 0.532 which is greater than .05. Therefore there is no statistically significant association between gender and Employee Engagement. This may be due to reasons such as equitable sharing of responsibilities at home, increased occurrence of options for hybrid work and efficient collaboration and more importantly better work-life balance.

Hypothesis - 3

H₀: There exists no significant relationship between hybrid work model and work life balance.

H₁: There exists a significant relationship between hybrid work model and work life balance.

Table 4.2.3: Relationship between hybrid work model and work life balance

	Hybrid Work Model	Work-Life balance
Hybrid Work Model	1 (.000)	.631 (.000)
Work-Life balance	.631 (.000)	1 (.000)

Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed)

Inference: From the above table it can be inferred that the probability value of correlation is 0.01 which is less than 0.05 level of significance so we reject null hypothesis. It can be concluded that there is relationship between hybrid work model and Work-life balance. Further, the correlation value is 0.631, this indicates that there is positive and moderate relationship between the two variables. Hybrid work model creates flexibility and paves way for a sustainable work-life balance by Reducing stress levels and creates some family time.

Hypothesis – 4

Table 4.2.4: Preferred primary modes of communication and corresponding Engagement

Primary modes of communication	Employee Engagement			
	Frequency	Percent	Mean	SD
Emails	34	42.5	1.8250	.86822
Phone Calls	29	36.3		
In-Person Communication	15	18.8		
Total	80	100.00		

Inference: It is inferred from Table 4.2.4 that a majority of the respondents use Email as a primary mode of communication and Employee Engagement (42.5) appears to be the highest in respondents using Emails. Phone calls are the second most common primary mode of communication .

CHAPTER-5

FINDINGS, SUGGESTIONS

AND CONCLUSION

5.1 Summary of findings

The information collected was analyzed and the key findings were gathered. They are listed below:

Demographic Variables

- ☐ More than half of the respondents (47%) of the respondents belong to the age group 20 to 25 years
- ☐ More than half the respondents (60%) are Female.
- ☐ More than half the respondents (55%) have at least an Undergraduate Degree.
- ☐ Some of the respondents (20%) are Engineers
- ☐ Most of the respondents (23%) belong to the Engineering Department, while 4% of the respondents belong to the Human Resources Department.
- ☐ Most of the respondents (85%) are unmarried.
- Most of the respondents (91.3%) do not have children.

Work Modes and Practices

- Most of the respondents (81.3%) have the freedom to choose where they can work from.
- Almost half of the respondents (48.8%) are currently working in a Hybrid Mode.
- More than half of the respondents (61.3%) prefer working in a Hybrid Mode.
- Almost half of the respondents (60%) prefer working remote to avoid daily commuting.
- Almost half of the respondents (36.3%) prefer working in-office for better team engagement and collaboration.
- Half of the respondents (58.8%) feel it is somewhat important for them to work only in the office.
- Almost one third of the respondents (41.3%) Wants to work at least 3 days in-office.
- Most of the respondents (61.3%) use Emails as a primary mode of communication.

- Almost half of the respondents (53.8%) conduct meetings in a hybrid mode.
- Almost half half of the respondents (42.5%) and their team members try to work in-office on the same day.
- Almost half half of the respondents (41.5%) agree that they feel like they are disconnected from the rest of the company in a hybrid mode.
- Almost half half of the respondents (44.5%) Strongly Agree that Hybrid work Mode Enhances work-life balance.
- Almost half half of the respondents (38.5%) Strongly Agree that hybrid work model allows for more opportunities to instill diversity and inclusion in the business.

Team Engagement

- Almost half of the respondents (46%) strongly agree that they focus hard on their work.
- Almost half of the respondents (46%) strongly agree that they focus hard on their work.
- Some of the respondents (25%) strongly agree that Engagement levels have fallen as a result of the hybrid work approach.
- Almost half of the respondents (37.5%) agree that People in a hybrid work environment would be more engaged and driven.
- ☐ Almost half of the respondents (36.5%) strongly agree that hybrid work approach has made it possible to communicate more easily
- Almost half of the respondents (47.6%) strongly agree that organization has invested in collaborative technologies to assist Hybrid Work Model.
- Half of the respondents (46%) agree that the organization actively seeks continuous feedback from its employees Through Surveys.

- ☐ On- Third of the respondents (26.2%) agree that they focus hard on their work.
- ☐ More than one third of the respondents (38%) agree that they share the same work goals as their colleagues.
- ☐ Almost half of the respondents (33.3%) agree that they feel positive about their work.
- ☐ Almost half of the respondents (33.7%) strongly agree that they feel energetic in their work.

Findings from statistical analysis

- ☐ There exists a significant difference in Employee Engagement among hybrid and non-hybrid work models.
- ☐ There is no significant relationship in Employee Engagement among male And Female Gender.
- ☐ There exists a significant relationship between hybrid work model and Employee Engagement.
- Emails are the primary mode of communication for a majority of the respondents and Engagement levels are higher among the users of this mode.

5.2 Suggestions:

A hybrid model enables flexibility for both employers and employees, which will be essential if we're to maintain high levels of engagement in the post-pandemic world. The following suggestions are emphasized in this regard:

- A common theme throughout the Research process was employee flexibility and Work -Life Balance . These two variables were praised by many informants as it is a key upside in an HW setup, even going to the extent of increasing employee engagement.
- **Define Your Company Culture:** Without clear direction from leadership, team members feel disconnected from their work and less willing to collaborate across departments and locations due to lack of clarity about what is expected of them.
- **Make Communication Accessible:**

One of the most important considerations when working in a hybrid model is ensuring that your organization invests in effective communications technology. Hybrid work can be intimidating, especially for managers who feel unfamiliar with how their employees interact with new technology. Employees can stay connected to valuable information while working remotely, rather than traveling between the office and headquarters, reducing personal expenses such as travel and lunchtime meals.

- **Listen Actively And Embrace Feedback:**

When your employees are engaged, they're more productive, committed, and satisfied. The only way to ascertain whether or not your employees are engaged is to listen actively. This isn't always easy and takes practice, but is essential for building a communicative workplace culture. If you'd like to build stronger relationships with your employees, here's a simple guide to becoming a better listener:

- Let them know that there's a safe space available where they can share things that are on their mind without judgment or repercussions (unless those repercussions will bring about positive change).
- People need to feel heard and taken seriously; establishing trust from this perspective can help foster real change in the workplace environment as well.

● **Meet Employees' Needs With Flexible Options**

One of the biggest challenges in increasing engagement in the hybrid workforce is meeting employee needs and expectations. This means giving them the opportunity to work wherever they feel most comfortable, such as at home, in the office, or a combination of both.

Providing flexible working hours and remote work options is a key component of a successful hybrid workforce. If flexible scheduling or remote options aren't available today, you should consider how to implement this in the future. Empower employees with access to the right technology so they can work from anywhere when they need to.

● **Deliberately Boost Employee Engagement**

On-site offices allow people to meet instantly and casually without formal planning. But in a remote environment, employees can feel isolated when left to their own devices. Managers should still maintain a certain structure and routines, as it was seen that combining routines and face-to-face interactions increase engagement. We would like to emphasize the importance for managers to be able to analyse a situation and the mood of their team members, in the instance of a negative feeling. Additionally, we would encourage managers to match individuals with certain tasks depending on their personality when going to the office.

5.3 Conclusion

- With the purpose to answer the research question regarding the implications of hybrid workplace on employee engagement, it can be concluded that employee engagement affected Either positively or negatively solely depends on the hybrid approach and workplace arrangements made by the organizations.
- With some elements of hybrid work being perceived as by-default positive factors on employee engagement, certain hybrid work conditions on other hand are interpreted as having a negative influence on employee engagement. Therefore, our research concludes that hybrid work implications on employee engagements are dependent on hybrid work design and implementation.
- Similarly, as flexibility, autonomy, and improved work-life balance can result in a hybrid setup positively affecting employee engagement, can isolation, overwork and weakened company culture have an equally negative impact on employee engagement.
- Organizations, targeting to achieve work engagement among their employees, should derive their hybrid workplace design decisions from purpose of the work tasks, exercise trust versus control-based leadership, facilitate regular communication, and make face-to-face meetings attractive to attend.
- In addition, new realities are forcing to rethink how corporate offices are designed. Especially when employees are expected to work onsite, the hybrid must meet the demands of the workplace and thereby maximize its positive impact on employee engagement..
- Our research shows that hybrid workplaces offer employees more flexibility and a better work-life balance, resulting in greater employee engagement while increasing productivity and performance efficiency for employers. The equation for achieving this positive outcome depends on the purpose-driven way you set up and implement your hybrid workplace.

APPENDIX

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QUESTIONNAIRE

Hello,

I'm Joanna Evangeline Crissy, a final year student pursuing my Masters in Human Resource Management (MA-HRM) at the Madras School of Social Work, Chennai.

This questionnaire serves as a tool to gather data for the study on the Implications of Hybrid Work Models on Employee Engagement.

Please answer all the questions truthfully and do note that there are no right or wrong answers. This may take 5 to 10 minutes to complete. The data collected will be kept confidential and will be used solely for academic purposes. Thank you in advance.

Demographics

1. Age
2. Gender a)Male b)Female c)Others
3. Educational Qualification a) UG c) PG d) Above PG
4. Designation
5. Department
6. Which industry would your company come under?
a) IT b) Manufacturing c) Service sector d) Other
7. Marital Status a) Married b) Un-married c)Separated
8. Do you have children? A)Yes B)No

Hybrid Work

Meaning: A hybrid work environment includes both **employees working in-office and remotely at a time.**

1. Does your company allow you to decide where you can work from?

a) Yes b) No

2. What is your current work mode?

a) In-office b) Remote c)Hybrid

3. Which work mode do you prefer?

a) Remote b) In-office c)Hybrid

4. If you chose 'Hybrid' which of the following influenced that decision?

a) Job Location (Different geographic location)

b) Daily commute

c) Childcare

d) All necessary equipment/resources already available for remote work

e) Your company mandates it

f)Enhanced Employee Engagement

g) Others

h)Not Applicable

5.If you chose 'remote' which of the following influenced that decision?

a) Better Work-life balance

b)Higher Productivity

c) Timeliness

d) Cost Saving

e) Reduced absenteeism

f) Others

h)Not Applicable

6. If you chose 'in-office' which of the following influenced that decision?

- a) Equipment/resource only available in-office
- b) Better team collaboration & engagement
- c) Your company mandates it.
- d) Your job can only be done in-office
- e) Better access to employee benefits
- f) Others
- g) Not Applicable

7. How 'important' it is for you to work from the office?

- a) Not at all important b) Somewhat important c) Extremely important

8. No. of days worked in-office in a week:

9. Mention your primary mode of communication

- a) Emails b) Phone c) In-person communication d) Others

10. Where do your Team Meetings occur?

- a) In-office b) Remote c) Hybrid

11. Is everyone from your team in office on the same days?

- a) Yes b) No

12. Do you feel like you are disconnected from the company?

- a) Strongly agree
- b) Agree
- c) Neutral
- d) Disagree
- e) Strongly Disagree

13. Hybrid Model Enhances work-Life Balance

- a) Strongly agree
- b) Agree
- c) Neutral
- d) Disagree
- e) Strongly Disagree

14.A Hybrid work Model Allows for more opportunities to instill diversity and inclusion in the business.

- a) Strongly agree
- b) Agree
- c) Neutral
- d) Disagree
- e) Strongly Disagree

EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT

15 Engagement levels have fallen as a result of hybrid work model

- a) Strongly agree
- b) Agree
- c) Neutral
- d) Disagree
- e) Strongly Disagree

16) People in a hybrid work environment would be more engaged and driven

- a) Strongly agree
- b) Agree
- c) Neutral
- d) Disagree
- e) Strongly Disagree

17) The Hybrid approach has made it possible to communicate easily

- a)Strongly agree
- b) Agree
- c)Neutral
- d)Disagree
- e)Strongly Disagree

18)To assist hybrid workers ,the organization has invested in collaborative technologies.

- a)Strongly agree
- b) Agree
- c)Neutral
- d)Disagree
- e)Strongly Disagree

1. Through surveys the organization actively seeks continuous feedback from its employees.

- a)Strongly agree
- b) Agree
- c)Neutral
- d)Disagree
- e)Strongly Disagree

19.) On a scale of 1-7, choose an option that resonates with you the most. 1 - Strongly disagree, 2 – Disagree, 3 - Somewhat disagree, 4 – Neutral, 5 - Somewhat agree, 6 – Agree, 7 - Strongly agree.

	1 - Strongly disagree	2 - Disagree	3 - Somewhat disagree	4 - Neutral	5 - Somewhat agree	6 - Agree	7 - Strongly agree
I focus hard on my work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I share the same work goals as my colleagues.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I feel positive about my work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I feel energetic enthusiastic in my work.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I am happy to take on additional tasks/responsibilities.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
I have an extremely low absence rate.	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

20) On a scale of 1-5, choose an option that resonates with you the most. (1-Not at all , 2-Weakly, 3-Moderately ,4-Strongly ,5-Very strongly)

a) How engaged are you in your organization

b) How has employee engagement changed in the hybrid workplace compared with Pre COVID-19?

21) How do you think Hybrid work Model Affects Employee Engagement?

22) How can we make hybrid work more productive and engaging?